

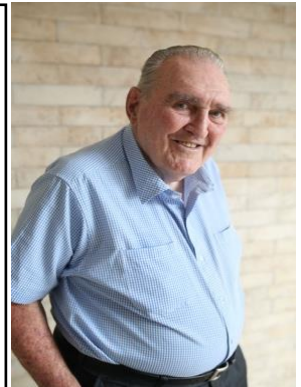


The Garamut
“The message sender”

Ps Barry's Reflections from 'The WORD'!

**For PRAYER,
PROCLAMATION &
PERSONAL PROGRESS**

**Bethel Global Missions
No.24 for of 13th July 2026**



MY SUBJECT TODAY IS THE MAN IN THE SYCAMORE TREE

Recently I was reflecting on the significant persons recorded in scripture that were associated with trees. I immediately thought of one person that stands out to me in the N.T. Gospels and the lessons learned from his life that can in practical terms be applied to our lives as followers of Christ.

The story is recorded in Luke 19:1-10- About a wealthy (rich) chief tax collector named Zacchaeus. Luke 19:1-10

1 Jesus entered Jericho and was passing through. - 2 A man was there by the name of Zacchaeus; he was a chief tax collector and was wealthy.

3 He wanted to see who Jesus was, but being a short man he could not, because of the crowd. NIV

3 He was trying to see who Jesus was, HOLMAN

3 He wanted to see who Jesus was, NCV

3 And he was seeking to see who Jesus was, ESV

3 And he was trying to see Jesus, which One He was, AMP

4 So he ran ahead and climbed a sycamore-fig tree to see him, since Jesus was coming that way. - 5 When Jesus reached the spot, he looked up and said to him, "Zacchaeus, come down immediately. I must stay at your house today." - 6 So he came down at once and welcomed him gladly. - 7 All the people saw this and began to mutter, "He has gone to be the guest of a 'sinner.'" - 8 But Zacchaeus stood up and said to the Lord, "Look, Lord! Here and now I give half of my possessions to the poor, and if I have cheated anybody out of anything, I will pay back four times the amount." - 9 Jesus said to him, "Today salvation has come to this house, because this man, too, is a son of Abraham. - 10 For the Son of Man came to seek and to save what was lost." NIV

IT IS OBVIOUS THAT ZACCHAEUS HAD HEARD ABOUT JESUS because Jesus had healed people at Jericho at a previous time.

Examples

Luke 18:35 A Blind Man Receives His Sight - Then it happened, as He was coming near Jericho, that a certain blind man sat by the road begging. NKJV also in Mark 10:46 and Matthew 20:29-30

Tax collectors

Tax collectors or publicans in the ancient Roman world gave them the right to collect regional taxes. Chief tax collectors, like Zacchaeus in Jericho, employed subordinates to squeeze money from the local population. Their profession was notoriously corrupt and widely despised. By collecting funds for the Roman Empire, local Jewish tax collectors were viewed as traitors who oppressed their own people to finance a foreign power. Tax collectors were not paid a salary; instead, their income came from whatever extra money they could force people to pay on top of Rome's official demands.

The order of events of Zacchaeus' encounter with Jesus

1. There were crowds that followed /surrounded Jesus
2. Zacchaeus DESIRED to see who Jesus was
3. But being a short man he could not
4. So, he RAN – AHEAD – and CLIMBED a sycamore tree to get a better view of who Jesus was
5. And Jesus SAW him up in the tree
6. And said come Zacchaeus DOWN - IMMEDIATELY – I MUST STAY in your house today

7. Zacchaeus replied Lord, I give half of my possessions to the poor, and if I have cheated anybody out of anything, I will pay back four times the amount." This O.T law is found in Exodus 22:1 and in Leviticus 6:4-5
8. Jesus responded with today salvation has come to this house.

NOTE:

A. ZACCHAEUS RAN – SHOWED INTENSITY OF PURPOSE IN SEEKING JESUS.

Application:

- We ALSO need to show an **INTENSITY** to see Jesus for who he is – that should be our purpose.

B. HE CLIMBED TO HAVE A BETTER VIEW OF WHO JESUS IS AND TO KNOW HIM BETTER

Application:

- Because Jesus is to be more to us than just a saviour, healer, deliverer, provider, baptiser in the Holy Spirit and soon coming king.
- HE is also our SHEPHERD KING, our LOVER, our BRIDEGROOM.

C. HE OVERCAME HIS DISABILITY OF BEING OF SMALL STATURE – HE CLIMBED A TREE.

Application:

- We need to use every effort to overcome our DISABILITY of fear, doubt or the complacency of the routineness of daily duty.
- We may need TO CLIMB OUT OF the disappointing, negative and sorrowful valleys of life – so we can have a better, clearer and RENEWED VIEW OF WHO JESUS IS.
- It will take effort.
- *Always make a total effort, even when the odds are against you. Arnold Palmer*
- *Productivity is never an accident. It is always the result of a commitment to excellence, intelligent planning, and focused effort. Paul J Meyer.*

Application:

- Yes, we have experienced a wonderful salvation **BUT** when was the last time that we had a fresh, renewed and intimate encounter with Christ?
- Has his **BRILLIANCE** to us been lost in the midst of our trials and the busyness of serving?
- Can we truly say now, today, **that he is altogether lovely and everything about him delights me; or has he somehow lost his lustre and attractiveness to us?**
- Has he become ordinary to us – e.g. just a teacher, a prophet etc.?

D. JESUS INVITED HIMSELF TO THE HOUSE OF THIS MAN IN THE SYCAMORE TREE.

- **Why do you think that he did that?**
- The answer can only be found in the CHANGED attitude of this man Zacchaeus.

E. SOMETHING HAPPENED IN THIS MAN IN THE TREE AS A DIRECT RESULT OF HIS ENCOUNTER WITH JESUS –

- Something must have happened in the conversations over the dinner table in that house to bring about the dramatic change in Zacchaeus's life.

Application:

- MEETING WITH JESUS **TRANSFORMS** PEOPLE'S LIVES.
- That's what happens when anyone has a direct personal encounter with Christ.
- When we are gladly welcomed Christ's invitation to come into our lives - **verse 6. So he came down at once and welcomed him gladly** - our lives will be TRANSFORMED, never to be the same again.
- It also brings about AWARENESS of one's wrongs and sins.
- It produces REPENTANCE and a willingness to make RESTITUTION – here there was no cheap repentance without seeking restitution (making right one's wrongs) **verse 8. But Zacchaeus stood up and said to the Lord, "Look, Lord! Here and now I give half of my possessions to the poor, and if I have cheated anybody out of anything, I will pay back four times the amount."**
- **AND WE ARE SAVED.**

Application:

- What an amazing story of a little man who climbed a sycamore tree and met Jesus and found the meaning of true life.
- What important steps are drawn from this story for us to follow and to present to others?